

Types of Belief in God

Theism

Theism is believing in the existence of God or believing in the existence of one or more divinities or deities. Islam, Christianity, Hinduism, Judaism, Sikhism, and Zoroastrianism are all theistic religions.

Atheism

Disbelief in God or in the existence of any divine being whatever is atheism. Many atheists tend towards secular philosophies such as Humanism and Naturalism. Atheism is primarily a reaction to, or a rejection of, religious belief, and thus does not determine other religious beliefs. Atheism has sometimes been associated with the philosophical ideas of materialism, which holds that only matter exists. Atheism may be implicit (someone who has never thought about belief in gods) or explicit (someone who has made an assertion, either weak or strong, regarding their lack of belief in gods). Confucianism, Taoism, Jainism and some varieties of Buddhism, either do not include belief in a personal god as a tenet of the religion, or actively teach nontheism.

Monotheism

Majority of the world has the view that only one God exists. The Abrahamic faiths - Judaism, Christianity and Islam-, as well as Plato's concept of God, all affirm monotheism. Jews, Christians and Muslims all agree that God is an eternally existent being that exists apart from space and time, who is the creator of the universe, and is omnipotent (all-powerful), omniscient (all-knowing), omnivolent (all-loving) and omnipresent (all-present).

Pantheism

The belief that God is equivalent to Nature or the physical universe, or that everything is of an all-encompassing immanent abstract God is widely common phenomenon even in the monotheistic religions. Almost in all major religions, many adherents have the belief in pantheism. The concept has been discussed as far back as the time of the philosophers of Ancient Greece, including Thales, Parmenides and Heraclitus.

Deism

It is a form of monotheism in which it is believed that one God exists, but that this God does not intervene in the world, or interfere with human life and the laws of the universe. It posits a non-interventionist creator who permits the universe to run itself according to natural laws.

Ditheism

Ditheism is the polytheistic belief in two equally powerful gods, one good and the other evil. Often, but not always, with complementary properties and in constant opposition, such as God of Good and Evil in Zoroastrianism and Manichaeism is the common property of ditheism.

Polytheism

As an anthropomorphic attribute, polytheism is the belief in, or worship of multiple gods. These gods are often seen as similar to humans in their personality traits, but with additional individual powers, abilities, knowledge or perceptions. Hard Polytheism views the gods as being distinct and separate beings, such as in Ancient Greek Mythology. Soft Polytheism views the gods as being subsumed into a greater whole, as in most forms of Hinduism.

Henotheism

Henotheism is the devotion to a single god while accepting the existence of other gods as like Hindu beliefs. Some inclusive monotheists perceive that each nation or country has its own god. It has been called monotheism in principle and polytheism in fact.

Animism

The belief that souls inhabit all or most objects whether they are; animals, vegetables, minerals or any significant physical objects such as statues or mountains is animism. Animistic religions generally do not accept a sharp distinction between spirit and matter, and assume that this unification of matter and spirit plays a role in daily life. Many indigenous African religions are animistic.

Agnosticism

Neither belief nor disbelief in the existence of the God or in the existence of any divine being whatever is agnosticism. The strong agnosticism is the belief that the nature and existence of gods is unknown and cannot ever be known or proven. But technically, in popular usage, a weak agnostic may just be someone who takes no position, pro or con, on the existence of gods, or who has not yet been able to decide, or who suspends judgment due to lack of evidence.

Humanism

Humanism is more an ethical process, not a dogma about the existence or otherwise of gods. In recent courses of time Humanism is a trendy debate among modern believers. But in general terms, it rejects the validity of transcendental justifications, such as a dependence on belief without reason, the supernatural, or texts of divine

origin. It is therefore generally compatible with atheism and agnosticism, but does not require these, and can be compatible with some religions. To some extent, it supplements or supplants the role of religions, and can be considered in some ways as equivalent to a religion.

Secularism

Secularism is the exclusion of religion from public affairs. It has the belief that religion and religious bodies should have no part in political or civic affairs or in running public institutions, especially state and schools. Sometimes it rejects a religious moral system and values. Strict secularists interpret secularism to mean that religion should remain outside of total public life and any public institution should not promote religious causes. Those who advocate a more flexible interpretation of secularism maintain that religious groups and causes should not be excluded from the public realm but not be promoted by any government institutes.